

Foot Care in Alberta

Help when money is tight • A plain language guide

Do your feet need care and you cannot afford it? There is help. Most of it is free.

Many people get stuck because they ask for “podiatry.” Alberta only pays a little for that. But there are other ways to get foot care, and they are free or covered. This guide shows you the doors that are open.

The one thing to know

“Podiatry” has a small budget. Alberta pays only 250 dollars a year for it.

But foot care from a **doctor** is free. There is no limit.

So do not ask for “podiatry.” Ask for the foot care you need, and aim for the free doors below.

The three main doors

1. Your family doctor

Your doctor can treat your feet for free. This covers infections, wounds, sore skin, and foot problems. Alberta Health Care pays the whole cost, with no limit. Just book your doctor and show your health card.

2. Home care (by assessment, so ask first)

Home care is not a set menu. It is decided by an assessment of what you cannot do yourself or get from another source. Alberta Health Services states plainly that home care does not provide all the services a person may need, and it points people to other supports in the community. Foot care and nail care are not listed as home care services. So do not count on routine nail care being covered.

If your feet are a medical concern, from wounds, diabetes, or ulcer risk, ask whether you qualify for foot care through a pathway. Call 811, ask what your own assessment covers, and get the answer for your file.

Source: Alberta Health Services, Home and Community Care, updated February 2026.

3. AISH pays for foot gear

AISH and AADL can pay for these things:

- Compression stockings
- Special or custom shoes
- Arch supports and orthotics
- Braces

If you are on AISH, you pay nothing extra for AADL. The fee most people pay is waived for you. Call Alberta Supports at 1-877-644-9992 to start, and keep your receipts.

What to do first

1. See your family doctor for the foot problem itself. Medical foot care by a doctor is covered, with no cap.
2. Call 811 to ask what your home care assessment covers. Foot care through home care is not guaranteed, so ask, do not assume.
3. Call Alberta Supports at 1-877-644-9992 for AADL shoes or stockings. Ask your AISH worker about orthotics.
4. Dial 211 to find a free or low cost foot clinic in your town.

If you have lymphedema, diabetes, or wounds

There are special clinics for this. They are free. Your doctor can send you.

- Wound clinics for sores that will not heal.
- Foot teams for feet at risk of ulcers.
- Lymphedema clinics for swelling. They also set you up with stockings through AADL.

Calgary lymphedema clinic: 403-955-6052

Edmonton lymphedema clinic: 780-735-2413

Free and low-cost clinics

- Dial 211 to find a foot clinic near you.
- Calgary: CUPS clinic, 403-389-2712.
- Edmonton: Radius Community Health foot clinic.

- Ask your doctor's clinic if they have a free foot nurse.

If you are First Nations, Inuit, or a veteran

- First Nations and Inuit: foot gear is covered. Call 1-855-618-6291.
- Veterans: foot care and gear are covered. Call 1-866-522-2122.

What will not help (so you do not waste time)

- The Alberta Adult Health Benefit does not pay for foot care, shoes, or orthotics.
- "Podiatry" only pays 250 dollars a year. Use the free doors instead.

Numbers to keep

Health Link: 811

Alberta Supports: 1-877-644-9992

Find local help: 211

AADL: 780-427-0731

This can feel like a maze. It was built like one. You do not have to figure it out alone. Message the group and we will help you pick the right door and fill out the forms with you. You should not have to fight this hard just to get your feet cared for.

This guide uses Alberta government, AHS, and federal information, current as of July 2026. Programs and clinic rules change, so please confirm the details that matter to you by phone before you count on them.

The Alberta Disability System Breakdown — Advocate

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